Negative Double

Partner opens 1 of a suit and the next opponent overcalls a suit:
Double by you is not for penalty - it says you **would** have responded if no overcall.
You need 6+ points for 1-level double, more for higher level double
Negative Double promises at least four cards in any unbid Major
If both Majors have been bid, double promises both minors
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - dbl - promises 4-card Spade suit
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - 1♠ - promises 5+ card Spade suit

Support Cue-bid

When partner opens and next player overcalls, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

When an opponent opens, partner overcalls, and the next opponent passes, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠3

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠J

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣2

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦3

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K J 7
♥ 8 7
♦ 9 7 6
♣ K Q 5 4

♠ 10 5
♥ J 10 9 2
♦ A K Q 5
♣ J 10 3



♠ 8 4 3
♥ Q 6 4
♦ J 10 3 2
♣ 9 8 7

♠ Q 9 6 2
♥ A K 5 3
♦ 8 4
♣ A 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	1♦	Dbl
Pass	1♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♠3

SOUTH has both Majors and planned on bidding 1♥ first, (up-the-line). But EAST's overcall gave SOUTH the opportunity to bid both Majors at the same time! Since the Negative Double promises both Majors it was like SOUTH could bid 1♥♠.

NORTH has ♠s so she bids 1♠, showing a minimum opener.

SOUTH has 13 points and the ♠ fit so he bids game.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 5 4 3 ♥ Q 5 4 ♦ Q 8 5 2 ♣ 7 6 3	
♠ A K 6 2 ♥ A 10 9 3 ♦ 9 7 ♣ Q 8 2		♠ Q 9 7 ♥ J 8 7 ♦ A K 6 ♣ K J 10 4
	♠ J 10 8 ♥ K 6 2 ♦ J 10 4 3 ♣ A 9 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♣	1♦
Dbl	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♠J

WEST has 13 points and four cards in both ♥s and ♠s. Rather than bid one of them she makes a Negative Double, promising four cards in EACH of them. It's like she was able to bid 1♥♠.

EAST doesn't have four cards in either Major, but with a ♦ stopper he bids 1NT.

WEST happily bids 3NT.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K J 7 ♥ 8 7 ♦ 9 7 6 ♣ K Q 5 4	
♠ 5 3 ♥ Q 10 6 4 ♦ A K 10 5 ♣ 10 9 8		♠ 10 8 4 ♥ J 9 3 2 ♦ Q J 3 2 ♣ J 7
	♠ Q 9 6 2 ♥ A K 5 ♦ 8 4 ♣ A 6 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	1♦	1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♦K

SOUTH cannot respond with a Negative Double on this hand because he has only three ♥s.

Instead he just bids his 4-card Major, 1♠.

NORTH shows 4-card support with a minimum opener by bidding 2♠ and SOUTH has enough strength to bid game.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ Q 7 4
♥ K 5 4
♦ Q 5 4
♣ J 6 3 2

♠ A 10 5 3 2
♥ A J 10
♦ 9 8 7
♣ A 8



♠ K 9
♥ 8 6 2
♦ A K 6 3
♣ K Q 7 5

♠ J 8 6
♥ Q 9 7 3
♦ J 10 2
♣ 10 9 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	2♥	Dbl	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♣2

EAST has 15 points, and when North overcalls 2♥ in front of her she has a perfect Negative Double - showing both of the Minor suits.

WEST doesn't like the Minor suits, but he has stoppers in ♥s, so he bids 2NT.

EAST is more than happy to raise to 3NT.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9
♥ K Q J 7
♦ A K 6
♣ A Q 10 5 4

♠ K 5 4 2
♥ 8 5
♦ J 10 7 5
♣ J 9 8



♠ A Q J 7 3
♥ 10 3
♦ Q 9 3 2
♣ 7 3

♠ 10 8 6
♥ A 9 6 4 2
♦ 8 4
♣ K 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	1♠	Dbl
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♦3

SOUTH would have responded 1♥ if EAST had not overcalled. But with only 8 points he cannot bid at the 2-level. The Negative Double solves his problem, giving this information to partner.

NORTH has good ♥s and enough points to bid game. Notice that if EAST had remained silent, SOUTH would have responded 1♥, and NORTH would have jumped to game.